Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Understanding the problem and choosing the best solution idea

1. Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, causing delays and manual overhead, especially for standard laptop orders. Configuration of a newly requested laptop is easy to overlook or delay, which frustrates users and wastes IT resources.

2. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Main Interest
Employee / Requester	Orders a standard laptop from the Service Catalog	Gets a configured laptop quickly
Approver	Approves the request (e.g. manager)	Clear, simple approval step
IT Procurement Team	Owns the ordering process	Less manual follow-up and fewer errors
Hardware Team	Configures the laptop on arrival	Tasks assigned automatically to their group

3. Empathy Map (IT Procurement Team Member)

Says	Thinks	Does	Feels
"Did the hardware team get the task?"	"Manual tasks are easy to miss."	Creates configuration tasks by hand and follows up by email	Frustrated by delays and rework
"Users keep asking for status."	"This should run automatically."	Tracks requests in spreadsheets	Overloaded, pressured

4. Brainstormed Ideas

#	Idea	Impact	Effort
1	Manually assign tasks with a checklist	Low	Low
2	Business Rule / script that creates tasks on approval	Medium	Medium (scripting, harder to maintain)
3	Flow Designer flow triggered from Service Catalog that creates a Catalog Task for the Hardware group	High	Low (no-code)
4	Full workflow with notifications and SLA tracking	High	High (future scope)

5. Selected Idea

Idea 3 was selected: a no-code Flow Designer flow that starts from the Service Catalog trigger, creates a Catalog Task with the short description "Laptop needs to Configured", and assigns it to the **Hardware** group. It gives the highest impact for the lowest effort and is easy to maintain.

6. Project Objectives

1. Give users a seamless experience with timely laptop configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and errors in procurement.
3. Improve IT resource use by optimising task allocation.
4. Improve overall efficiency and productivity of IT procurement.